

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12415587
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
Inventor(s)	Liu; Zi-Ju

Grip with accident notification functions and system thereof

Abstract

A grip having accident notification functions and associated system are disclosed. The grip has portions of front, middle and rear. The front portion is overlaid on the handlebar surrounded with multiple component modules. The middle portion having multiple wiring slot. The rear portion has a radially disposed main circuit board and an axially disposed antenna. The main circuit board has an accident notification system and is electrically connected to the antenna. The accident notification system based on an anomaly determination rule, which sends out a notify signal to an external telecom terminal through the antenna, when an anomaly of the grip is determined. Therefore, the grip is able to achieve on emergency detection and notification by integrating the accident notification system and novel ways of deploying antenna into a such narrow space inside the grip.

Inventors:	Liu; Zi-Ju (Taoyuan, TW)
Applicant:	Liu; Zi-Ju (Taoyuan, TW)
Family ID:	1000008820223
Appl. No.:	18/653265
Filed:	May 02, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240367747 A1	Nov. 07, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

TW	112116833	May. 05, 2023
----	-----------	---------------

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: B62K21/26 (20060101); B60R21/013 (20060101); B60R21/00 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC B62K21/26 (20130101); B60R21/013 (20130101); B60R2021/0027 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
8402664	12/2012	Kitamura	33/1PT	B62K 23/04
2017/0080993	12/2016	Bierwerth	N/A	B62M 25/08
2018/0156631	12/2017	Huard	N/A	B62K 21/26

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
207697899	12/2017	CN	N/A

Primary Examiner: Johnson; Vicky A

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Birch, Stewart, Kolasch & Birch, LLP

Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims priority to Taiwan Application Serial Number 112116833, filed May 5, 2023, which are herein incorporated by reference.

FIELD OF INVENTION

(2) The present disclosure relates to a grip and an accident notifying system, and more particularly to a grip that can automatically report the location of the accident and emergency contacts as the accident occurs.

DESCRIPTION OF RELATED ARTS

(3) With the progress of communication technology development, many emergency notification systems have been developed with communication technologies such as GSM, narrowband internet of things (NB-IoT) and satellites. The system allows a person to make communications with mobile devices in outdoors or dangerous environments. The system can further real-time sent out locations and distress signals in several unexpected conditions such as an accident occurs.

(4) However, such products are not easy to promote to the market, only few can be considered promising in business are integrated into electronic smart watch, mobile phone or electric vehicles. The main reason is that most products are solely designed and manufactured without the considerations of incorporating with third party devices in actual practice. Simply hanging or wearing such notification devices through external connecting mechanisms are often found stupid and silly.

(5) Moreover, using two-wheel bicycle as examples, the notification device is commonly seen to be

mounted on the handlebar, underneath the seat cushion, the down tube, the seat tube or even wore on human through external accessories known as non-standardized attachment or plug-in. Nevertheless, none of above-mentioned locations are good. Not only signals are too easy to have interference or be shielded, but there are also too many possibilities and reasons to make accident happened. Sensing unexpected conditions may not come from the bicycle or external impacts, and more is from the notification device itself. The non-standardized installation cannot fully reflect situations between the vehicle body and the user's actual operation, which results of the accurate of sensing accident being low.

(6) Therefore, without affecting the accurate of sensing and the reliable communications, there's a need for accident notifications device, which are able to integrate software and hardware into the vehicles without using any external non-standardized attaching components.

SUMMARY OF THE PRESENT DISCLOSURE

(7) According to an aspect of the present disclosure, a grip with accident notification function is provided. In one embodiment, a grip comprises a hollow tube, at least one antenna and a cover. The hollow tube has opening at respectively sides that communicates to each other, and sequentially comprises a front portion, a middle portion and a rear portion.

(8) The front portion has multiple component slots formed on the surface of the front portion. Each component slot is configured to accommodate a component module. The middle portion has multiple wiring slots formed on the surface of the middle portion, and each wiring slot is communicating with the corresponding component slot. The rear portion has a protrusion protruded radially and inwardly along an inner wall of the rear portion that is configured for mounting a main circuit board and in which creates a first space and a second space within the rear portion. The second space communicates to the middle portion.

(9) The antenna is placed and electrically connected to the main circuit board in inside the first space. The main circuit board has an accident notification system that sending a notify signal to an external telecom terminal via the antenna.

(10) The cover overlays the hollow tube from the rear portion toward the front portion, and the handlebar is inserted from the opening corresponded to the front portion into the hollow tube.

(11) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, an accident notification system which is placed inside a grip, and comprises a motion data retrieving module, a data monitoring module, a positioning module and a communicating module. The motion data retrieving module obtains a motion data of the grip at a sampling frequency. The data monitoring module continuously receives the motion data, and send out a warning signal when an anomaly is determined that based on an anomaly determination rule. The positioning module obtains a location data. The communicating module generates a notify signal and transmitting the notify signal to an external telecom terminal, which is according to the warning signal.

(12) Accordingly, the grip is able to achieve on emergency detection and notification by integrating the accident notification system and novel ways of deploying antenna into a such limiting space inside the grip.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is an exemplary diagram illustrating an accident notification system in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure;

(2) FIG. 2 is a functional block diagram in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 3 is an exemplary diagram illustrating a grip with accident notification functions in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure;

- (4) FIG. 4 is a section view of the hollow tube of FIG. 3;
- (5) FIG. 5 is a flowchart of an anomaly determination rule in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (6) FIG. 6 is a flowchart of an anomaly determination rule in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (7) FIG. 7 is an exemplary diagram illustrated a grip used on a handlebar of a bicycle in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure; and
- (8) FIG. 8 is a block diagram illustrated an accident notification system adapted for the grip of FIG. 7.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (9) With reference to FIGS. 1 and 2, FIG. 1 is an exemplary diagram illustrating an accident notification system in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure; and FIG. 2 is a functional block diagram in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. In one embodiment, an accident system is placed inside a grip 10. The grip 10 is connected to an end of a handlebar 12. The handlebar 12 may be a pole or pestle such as sticker of mountain climbing. The grip-type accident notification system comprises a motion data retrieving module 20, a data monitoring module 22, a positioning module 24 and a communicating module 26.
- (10) The motion data retrieving module 20 is used for obtaining a motion data of the grip 10 at a sampling frequency. In one embodiment, the motion data retrieving module 20 may be a six-axis motion sensor used to obtain acceleration components and angular velocity changes in the X, Y, and Z axes.
- (11) The data monitoring module 22 may be a micro control unit (MCU) 220 and is used for continuously receiving the motion data from the motion data retrieving module 20. The data monitor module 22 further comprises a storage unit 222. The storage unit 222 has a predetermined anomaly determination rule. The MCU 220 adjust the sampling frequency of the motion data retrieving module 20 based on the anomaly determination rule as to dynamically determine if an anomaly of the grip 10 occurs.
- (12) The positioning module 24 is used for obtaining a location data of the grip 10. The data monitoring module 22 generates a warning signal when an anomaly of the grip 10 is determined. The communicating module 26 is connected to the data monitoring module 22, receiving the warning and is used for generating a notify signal with the location data and transmitting the notify signal to an external telecom terminal 28.
- (13) The positioning module 24 mainly for identify the location information of a person who is using the grip 10, and it can be implemented in technologies including GSM, NB-IoT, WIFI, Bluetooth or GPS. The communicating module 26 can also uses technologies such as GSM, NB-IoT, WIFI or Bluetooth for sending the notify signal to the external telecom terminal 28. Therefore, the positioning module 24 and the communicating module 26 of the present disclosure are not distinguished and defined by devices, but by functional means.
- (14) The telecom terminal 28 can be considered as a recipient for receiving the notify signal, which is not limited to a single signal station, which forming a cloud platform of internet connections. In one embodiment, the notify signal further includes an identification code. The telecom terminal 28 has an emergency contact information corresponded to the identification code. When telecom terminal 28 received the notify signal, it can notify through the corresponding emergency contact information. The emergency contact information can be multiple, including not only the contact person set by the user, but also the police station, fire department, and even diplomatic agency in the corresponding base station area.
- (15) The identification code has a media access control (MAC) address, each MAC address is unique that can be used as a verification of the owner of the grip 10. It serves as an identity registration of reporting accidents. Therefore, if the grip 10 is stolen, the function of accident notification can be limited and further achieve anti-theft effects.

(16) With further reference to FIGS. 3 and 4, FIG. 3 is an exemplary diagram illustrating a grip with accident notification functions in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure; and FIG. 4 is a section view of the hollow tube of FIG. 3. In this embodiment, the grip **10** has a hollow tube **100** and a cover **102**. The hollow tube **100** has opening at respectively sides communicated to each other, and sequentially has a front portion **110**, a middle portion **120** and a rear portion **130**. The handlebar **12** is inserted from the opening corresponded to the front portion **110** into the hollow tube **100**, which the end of the handlebar **12** is penetrated against inside the middle portion **120**. The cover **102** overlays the hollow tube **100** to form the grip **10**.

(17) The surface of the front portion **110** forms multiple component slots **112** and each component slot **112** is used for accommodating a component module (not shown). The surface of the middle portion **120** has formed multiple wiring slots **122**, and each wiring slot **122** is communicating with the corresponding component slot **112**. The number of the wiring slots **122** is fewer than the number of the component slots **112**. In other words, multiple component slots **112** can share with a wiring slot **122**. In side the middle portion **120** has an inner accommodation **123** which may place a battery as a power source. However, if the grip **10** can be powered by the control system of the bicycle itself, the battery can be used as a backup battery. The inner accommodation **123** does not necessarily used to receive the battery, other electronic component can be also applicable which extends its flexibility of the space. To avoid excessive complexity in schematic drawing, the drawing of signal or power lines used for electrical conductivity will be omitted. This part does not affect the implementation of the present invention by those skilled in the art.

(18) As shown in FIG. 4, the contour of the inner wall of the rear portion **130** further comprises a protrusion **131** radially and inwardly protruded, which is used for holding a main circuit board **140**. The main circuit board **140** may electrically connect to the battery and makes the inner space of the rear portion **130** being defined with a first space **132** and a second space **133**. The outer wall of the rear portion **130** corresponded to the first space **132** have a pair of opposite windows **134** and antenna slots **135**, multiple notches **136** and a receptacle slot **137**. Each window **134** corresponded to the main circuit board **140** has an auxiliary circuit board **134b** that being axially placed. The second space **133** communicates to the middle portion **120**.

(19) The auxiliary circuit board **134b** can have different functional components **134c** or combination of function components **134c** according to actual application. For example, the function component **134c** may be a light emitting unit, a radiofrequency unit or an antenna unit. In one embodiment, the function component **134c** is a LED light, the LED light is installed on the auxiliary circuit board **134b** facing outside the window **134** and the light is radially emitted outside the hollow tube **100** through the transparent portion of the window **134**.

(20) The antenna slot **135** is used for receiving a first antenna **135a**. The notches **136** is which are corresponding formed to allow the inner space of the rear portion **130** being communicates to the antenna slot **135** and the wiring slot **122**. The component module inside the component slot **112** and the first antenna **135a** of the antenna slot **135** can selectively being electrically connected via wire to the main circuit board **140** or the auxiliary circuit board **134b**. The receptacle slot **137** receives a data communication interface electrically connected to the main circuit board **140**. A person can charge the battery through the receptacle slot **137**, and/or access data stored inside the main circuit board **140** or the auxiliary circuit board **134b**. However, when the grip **10** is powered by the electric control system of the bicycle itself, the grip **10** may become a DC hub that discharge externally through the receptacle slot **137**. Moreover, even if the grip **10** is equipped with a battery and powered by the electric control system of the bicycle as independent power source, the main circuit board **140** may switch the power source according to the discharging target.

(21) In one embodiment, the main circuit board **140** is a double-side printed circuit board having a first surface **140a** and a second surface **140b**. The first surface **140a** corresponds to the first space **132**, and the second surface **140b** corresponds to the second space **133**. On the first side **140a**, a second antenna **135b** can be arranged in parallel. The positioning module **24** and the

communicating module **26** are respectively electrically connected to the first antenna **135a** or the second antenna **135b** through the antenna connection seat **141** set on the first side **140a**. it is worth noting that due to the limited space inside the grip **10**. Since the first antenna **135a** and the second antenna **135b** are located in the radial and axial directions of the grip sleeve **10**, a high angle range of radio frequency above 270 degrees can be achieved. In addition, the inner accommodation **123** is communicated with the second space **133**, the battery or the electronic component provided in the inner accommodation **123** is electrically connected to the second side **140b** of the main circuit board **140**.

(22) The motion data retrieving module **20** and the data monitoring module **22** can be selectively mounted on either the first side **140a** or the second side **140b** of the main circuit board **140**. These two modules do not have high requirements for the shelter clearance. Accordingly, such configuration and arrangement has achieved the highest space utilization, communication efficiency and signal reception effects.

(23) Furthermore, with reference to FIGS. **1** and **4**, when the grip **10** is used in the applications of mountain climbing or associated poles, the grip **10** may further comprise an emergency button **142** electrically connected to the first surface **140a** of the main circuit board **140**. The electronic component inside the component slot **112** can be a headlight module and a buzzer respectively. When a person encounters emergency or accident, the emergency button **142** can be triggered to transmit the notify signal. The headlight module and the buzzer simultaneously turned on for assistance, so that nearby people or search teams can hear the sound or see the light to increase success rescue time.

(24) With reference to FIG. **5**, FIG. **5** is a flowchart of an anomaly determination rule in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. The anomaly determination rule for determining the anomaly of the grip comprises acts of **S300** obtaining signal vector magnitude (SVM) means by continuously calculating the SVM of the motion data; **S310** determining the grip motion based on the SVM mean; and **S320** an anomaly is determined if the count that the SVM exceeded SVM mean is greater than a threshold. In one embodiment, the vector intensity of the motion sensor is different for a person holding mountain climbing poles in uphill, downhill and walking on a flat road. In general, the SVM mean for walking on a flat will be the lowest, while the SVM in the movement of downhill is the highest. Bias in addition for the flatness of the road and health conditions for each individual. In order to improved the accuracy and reduce the probability of misjudgment, sampling frequency of retrieving will change according to different grip motion which is determined based on the SVM mean. In some embodiment, the sampling frequency is linear related to the SVM mean.

(25) TABLE-US-00001 Uphill Flat Downhill SVM mean >0.35 g <0.03 g >0.9 g Sampling frequency 80 Hz 60 Hz 120 Hz

(26) Above table is an example shows the relationship between the sampling frequencies and SVM means. When the sampling frequency is increasing from 60 Hz to 80 Hz or even 120 Hz, in the same period of time, the SVM value should be lower than the SVM means unless an accident occurs. For example, when a person is downhill, the threshold is set to 15. If the SVM of 15 consecutive sampling points is greater than 0.9 g, the data monitoring module **22** will determine the grip motion is abnormal. A warning signal will be generated. The setting of the threshold value can be adjusted according to different applications. Lower threshold value will increase sensitivity, while the over sensitivity may cause system misjudgment.

(27) The present disclosure integrates the values of the acceleration and angle in the X, Y and Z directions of the grip. Utilizing the degree of intense changes in grip as basis, the method for determining accident is dynamically adjusting the sampling frequency of retrieving SVM in which successfully reduces the probability of misjudgment. As for the calculation of SVM value, it is well-known to those skilled in the field and will not be elaborated upon here.

(28) With reference to FIG. **6**, FIG. **6** is a flowchart of an anomaly determination rule in accordance

with another embodiment of the present disclosure. In this embodiment, the anomaly determination rule further comprises a loosen mode. Unlikely other conventional notification system, the unique feature of the grip type accident notification system is that in the event of an accident such as falling into a valley, the mountain climbing poles may be thrown out. The movement of the grip may be in situations of losing gravity or rolling causing chaotic SVM readings. However, the movement of the grip will eventually stop. Therefore, after the data monitoring module **22** sent out a first warning signal, the anomaly determination rule of determining the loosen mode comprising act of **S400** stop calculating SVM for a predetermined period of time (e.g., 1 minute) and then **S410** using the highest sampling frequency (e.g., 180 Hz) to interpret the intensity of SVM; and **S420** if the SVM value is less than 0.03 g of a threshold value (ideally 0 g) for 15 consecutive times, the data monitoring module will determine the grip is in the loosen mode and consider the grip has left the person and in a static state. At this time, the system will issue another warning signal.

(29) With reference to FIGS. 7 and 8, FIG. 7 is an exemplary diagram illustrated a grip used on a handlebar of a bicycle in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure; FIG. 8 is a block diagram illustrated an accident notification system adapted for the grip of FIG. 7. In this embodiment, two grips are mounted on respectively ends of the handlebar forming a left handle and a right handle. The two grips may work independently or corporate with each other. For example, the data monitoring module is placed in a grip, and the positioning module and communicating module are placed in another grip. Two grips can communicate with each other in wire or wireless.

(30) As shown in FIG. 8, the left handle is the first grip **60** and the right handle is the second grip **70**. The first grip **60** has a motion retrieving module **62**, a data monitoring module **64**, a positioning module **66** and a communicating module **68**. The second grip **70** has a motion retrieving module **72**, a communicating module **74** and a power source **76**. The data monitoring module **64** is the main controller of the accident notification system, and receives the data collected from the motion retrieving modules **62**, **72**. The positioning module **66** is a GPS module. The communicating module **66** has functions of NB-IoT and Bluetooth. The communicating module **74** has functions of GSM and Bluetooth. The communications between the communicating module **66** and the communicating module **74** are using Bluetooth. The power source **76** provides power to all abovementioned modules, and may be a lithium-ion battery.

(31) Assuming that when a bicycle overturns and falls to the right, the motion retrieving module **72** of the second grip **70** will firstly sense severe collisions including frictions and rebounds with the ground, which is the fastest module detecting such sudden accident. As above described, the learning and analysis of SVM vectors can enable users to more accurately understand the situations they may encounter in application scenarios, accident scenarios, and even model predictions to reflect the situations of both cane users and cyclists. This enables the system to more accurately and accurately report the current situation of users, enabling more effective understanding and assistance from external rescue units, rather than wasting meaningless resources or missing the golden rescue time.

(32) Accordingly, an accident notification system involves not only the design and integration of device mechanisms, layout planning and component settings, hardware and firmware parameter values, and software systems into a very space limited grip, but also the adaptation of the actual use of the grip and the effective antenna layout, thereby achieving more accurate emergency detection and effective notification.

(33) Although the present disclosure has been disclosed above with embodiments, it is not intended to limit the present disclosure. Any person having ordinary skill in the art can make various changes and modifications without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. Therefore, the protection scope of the present disclosure should be defined by the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A grip comprising: a hollow tube having opening at respectively sides that communicates to each other, and sequentially comprising: a front portion having multiple component slots formed on the surface of the front portion, wherein each component slot is configured to accommodate a component module; a middle portion having multiple wiring slots formed on the surface of the middle portion, wherein each wiring slot is communicating with the corresponding component slot; and a rear portion having a protrusion protruded radially and inwardly along an inner wall of the rear portion that is configured for mounting a main circuit board and in which creates a first space and a second space within the rear portion, wherein the second space communicates to the middle portion; at least one antenna being placed and electrically connecting to the main circuit board in inside the first space, wherein the main circuit board has an accident notification system that sending a notify signal to an external telecom terminal via the antenna; and a cover overlaying the hollow tube from the rear portion toward the front portion, wherein the handlebar is inserted from the opening corresponded to the front portion into the hollow tube.
2. The grip as claimed in claim 1, wherein the hollow tube further comprises at least one antenna slot formed on the outer wall of the rear portion and corresponded to the first space which allows a first antenna being axially placed inside the antenna slot, and being electrically connected to the main circuit board.
3. The grip as claimed in claim 2, further comprising a second antenna being mounted inside the first space and being paralleled to the main circuit board.
4. The grip as claimed in claim 2, wherein the rear portion further comprises multiple notches which are corresponding formed to allow the inner space of the rear portion being communicates to the antenna slot and the wiring slot.
5. The grip as claimed in claim 4, wherein: the rear end of the handlebar is penetrated against inside the middle portion, which creates an inner accommodation in a place corresponded to the middle portion, wherein the inner accommodation is configured for receiving a power source or an electronic component which electrically connects to the main circuit board; and the outer wall of the rear portion corresponding to the first space has a receptacle slot, and the receptacle slot receives a data communication interface for charging the power source or accessing data from the main circuit board.
6. The grip as claimed in claim 4, wherein the main circuit board has a motion data retrieving module, a data monitoring module, a positioning module and a communicating module, wherein the positioning module and the communicating module are disposed at the first surface of the main circuit board, and the motion data retrieving module and the data monitoring module are selectively disposed at the second surface.
7. The grip as claimed in claim 4, wherein the outer wall of the rear portion RF components corresponding to the first space has a receptacle slot, and the receptacle slot receives a data communication interface that is electrically connected to the main circuit board.
8. The grip as claimed in claim 1, wherein the rear portion corresponding to the first space has at least one window, the window allows an auxiliary circuit board to be axially placed, the auxiliary circuit board is electrically connected to the main circuit board, and has at least one functional component, wherein the function component is a light emitting unit, a radiofrequency unit and an antenna unit.
9. The grip as claimed in claim 1, further comprising: an emergency button being disposed corresponded to the rear portion, wherein the emergency button is configured for triggering the transmission of the notify signal and selectively driving the component module insides the component slots.
10. The grip as claimed in claim 9, wherein the component module is a headlight module and a

buzzer.

11. An accident notification system placed inside a grip, the accident notification system comprising: a motion data retrieving module configured for obtaining a motion data of the grip at a sampling frequency; a data monitoring module configured for continuously receiving the motion data, and sending out a warning signal when an anomaly being determined that based on an anomaly determination rule; a positioning module configured for obtaining a location data; and a communicating module configured for generating a notify signal and transmitting the notify signal to an external telecom terminal, which is according to the warning signal.

12. The accident notification system as claimed in claim 11, wherein the notify signal has an identification code, and the telecom terminal has an emergency contact information corresponded to the identification code.

13. The accident notification system as claimed in claim 11, wherein the anomaly determination rule comprises an impact mode and a loosen mode.
